

centralised management, it largely depends on the scope and size of the hotel. That cost starts at around ₹ 200,000.”

The payback is quick. Sanghi says, “Indian hotels should invest at least two per cent of their revenue in technology. ROI starts coming in as soon as three to six months, and increases the revenue by at least five per cent within this period itself.”

Scopes of solutions: businesses in India

Hotel management encircles multiple aspects, ranging from asset and resource management, workforce, complimentary services offered to guests and more. Technology solution providers can take up each of these areas to create niche offerings or produce a complete end-to-end solution.

For instance, Mumbai-based BuildTrack delivers guest room automation and centralised control of hotel operations. Sivan says, “Guest room automation allows the guests to control features like lighting, air-conditioning, curtains, TV and other media devices, room service, laundry service, spa reservations and so on.

“The hotel operations solution pertains to safety monitoring, such as smoke sensors, gas leak sensors, perimeter security and so forth. It also addresses central control for common area lighting, ACs, pumps, elevator status and the like.”

Hotelogix offers an end-to-end cloud-based management platform that focuses on all operational ver-



Guest room automation solution by BuildTrack (Credit: buildtrack.in)

ticals, including front desk activities (like check-in management and guest requests), housekeeping activi-

Challenges in the business

Sanghi explains the challenges related to awareness among customers.

He elaborates, “Hotel owners who had installed older server-based solutions, say, seven years ago, are not keen on upgrading to modern solutions. They do not recognise the long-term benefits they are missing out on, nor the importance of scalability and a future-proof solution.

“On the other hand, in case of hotels that have not used technology at all, the challenge is adoption.”

Reports suggest that India’s low labour costs prevent small- and medium-sized hotels from investing in automation. However, industry players are of different opinions. Sivan says, “Lower labour cost is not an issue. Automation is intended to allow hotels to operate in a more structured manner with fewer people, but be a lot more reliable and cost-efficient.”

Sanghi confirms, “The solutions streamline the manual processes, making the activities easier to execute. These not only reduce time and effort invested in these activities, but also errors made by manual recordings, preventing dissatisfied customer experience.”

—Paromik Chakraborty, technical journalist, EFY



Hotelogix platform makes hotel management easier (Credit: Hotelogix.com)

ties, guest room automation, appliance control along with centralised monitoring that provides data-driven insights.

Chennai-based Hotspot Express provides a Wi-Fi automation solution to hotels. Their latest offering, called HotEx Mini, is a plug-and-play device that connects with the hotel’s Wi-Fi router. It provides secure Wi-Fi access to hotel guests via authentication. This allows hotel owners to customise individual Internet usage permissions. A single device can support up to 50 rooms.



Representative image of BuildTrack’s hotel operations solutions